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Proxy-Led Accord

Stabilization

A Peace-by-Proxy Framework for US-Iran De-escalation, Hormuz Governance, Nuclear Stabilization, and Regional Security Through Deniable Proxy Coalitions

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Preamble: The May 2026 Moment

"We were getting ready to do a very major attack tomorrow, and I've put it off for a little while, hopefully maybe forever." — President Donald J. Trump, May 18, 2026

Current Standoff: The Impasse of May 19, 2026

As of May 20, 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to renewed large-scale military confrontation since hostilities began in late February 2026. On May 18, President Trump announced he had called off a planned "very major attack" on Iran scheduled for May 19 at the request of Gulf allies Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and the United Arab Emirates, citing "serious negotiations now taking place."

The current impasse is defined by five irreconcilable direct demands:

Table 1 The May 2026 Impasse: Irreconcilable Direct Demands

Party	Demand	Why the Other Side Cannot Accept Directly
United States	Iran delivers 400kg of enriched uranium to the United States	Iran cannot surrender sovereign nuclear material directly to its adversary; this would constitute capitulation, not diplomacy
	Iran maintains only one operational nuclear facility	Iran views multiple facilities as sovereign right and insurance against single-point attack; dismantling equals disarmament
	Link nuclear negotiations to cessation of all hostilities	Iran cannot accept that proxy forces in Lebanon, Gaza, and Yemen become bargaining chips in nuclear talks
Iran	Full war reparations for damages	US Congress and electorate will not authorize payments to a state designated as hostile; implies US admission of fault
	Release of 100% of frozen assets	Trump has explicitly refused to release at least 25%; releasing all assets removes leverage and invites Congressional revolt
	Sovereign control of Strait of Hormuz	US maintains Hormuz is international waterway; ceding control would legitimize Iranian chokehold on global energy

These demands cannot be resolved through direct bilateral negotiation. Each represents a core sovereignty claim that neither capital can surrender without domestic political catastrophe. The direct negotiation format has produced only deadlock, escalating threats, and a planned military attack halted at the last moment by third-party intervention.

Why Proxy-Led Architecture Now

The Proxy-Led Stabilization Accord (PLSA) inverts the traditional diplomatic model. In conventional frameworks, proxies are treated as spoilers or deniable tools of asymmetric warfare. The PLSA flips this dynamic: proxies become deniable instruments of peace, allowing both Washington and Tehran to execute high-stakes diplomatic maneuvers without taking direct domestic political heat.

This model provides both capitals with what they most need in May 2026:

- **For Washington:** A pathway to secure Iranian nuclear material, open Hormuz, and stabilize the region without signing a "weak deal" directly with Tehran, without transferring reparations, and without releasing all frozen assets
- **For Tehran:** A pathway to secure sanctions relief, maintain Hormuz influence, preserve sovereign nuclear rights, and obtain reconstruction resources without surrendering enriched uranium directly to the United States or dismantling its enrichment capability

The PLSA creates a structural shield for both leaderships. If an administrative step fails, the Principal simply condemns "proxy operational friction" and tasks neutral channels with fixing it. The framework never triggers immediate state-to-state war.

Section 1: Core Architecture — The Double Insulated Buffer

In the PLSA framework, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran never sign a direct bilateral treaty, nor do they directly coordinate actions. Instead, they act as **Principal Guarantors** who sit behind two distinct, formalized proxy coalitions.

Table 2 The Double Insulated Buffer: Architecture Overview

Layer	Western Side	Iranian Side	Interface
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Principal Guarantor	United States		Islamic Republic of Iran	No direct contact
Proxy Coalition	Western Financial (WMFC)	Maritime & Coalition	Axis of Regional Stability (ARS)	The Pact — bilateral proxy-to-proxy agreements
Neutral Facilitating States	Oman, Switzerland, Qatar, Pakistan, IAEA, UN			Oversight, escrow, verification, mediation

1.1 The Western Maritime & Financial Coalition (WMFC)

The WMFC comprises the United Kingdom, specialized Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) task forces, Switzerland, and Oman. They act as the operational and legal proxies for the United States.

Table 3 WMFC Composition and Functions

Member	Domain	Proxy Function
United Kingdom	Maritime Security / Diplomatic Hosting	Hosts asymmetric security forums; provides naval escort for transit corridors; politically shields US from direct engagement with ARS actors
GCC Task Force (UAE, Saudi Arabia, Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar)	Maritime Patrol / Economic Bridge	Provides regional naval patrol replacing direct US presence; offers regional banking corridors for sanctions-compliant trade
Switzerland	Financial Escrow / Verification	Administers all escrow accounts; verifies asset transfers; provides neutral financial oversight shielding US Treasury from direct Iranian transactions
Sultanate of Oman	Maritime Deconfliction / Political Relay	Manages Hormuz transit oversight; hosts proxy negotiations; provides 24/7 hotline management

1.2 The Axis of Regional Stability (ARS)

The ARS formally reconstitutes Iran's regional network into an integrated regional policing bloc. They act as the operational proxies for Tehran.

Table 4 ARS Composition and Functions

Member		Domain	Proxy Function
Ansar (Houthis)	Allah	Red Sea / Gulf of Aden Maritime	Signs localized Maritime Freedom Pact; declares moratorium on commercial vessel targeting; collects environmental transit tariff via Omani Maritime Trust
Kata'ib Hezbollah & Iraqi PMF Elements		Border Security / Drone Buffers	Signs border-security stabilization agreements; commits to drone-free buffer zones; provides proxy policing of commercial lines
Government of Iraq (Cooperative Elements)		Security Forum Hosting	Hosts asymmetric security forum in Baghdad; provides legitimacy umbrella for ARS-WMFC engagement
Omani Trust	Maritime	Revenue Collection / Escrow	Collects synchronized transit tariffs; routes funds to third-party logistical escrow; provides cash flows without Iranian state directly charging fees

1.3 The De-Risking Principle

Article 1.3 — The De-Risking Principle

If a proxy coalition member violates a timeline, commits an unauthorized attack, or otherwise breaches its proxy obligations, the Principal Guarantors (US/Iran) shall not treat such violation as state-to-state hostile action. Instead, the Principals shall:

1. Issue coordinated condemnation of the "operational friction" through the Joint Coordination Secretariat
2. Task the neutral facilitating states (Oman, Switzerland) with investigating and remedying the violation
3. Maintain all other proxy-to-proxy commitments unchanged
4. Refrain from military retaliation against the other Principal's territory, forces, or official state institutions

This principle is the structural heart of the PLSA. It transforms what would traditionally trigger war into a manageable law-enforcement problem handled by proxies and neutral facilitators.

Section 2: Core Principles

2.1 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

Principle: Neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment is matched by a corresponding US commitment, activated simultaneously, verified by neutral observers through the distributed facilitating state matrix.

The Waltz Pairing is the fundamental transaction unit of the PLSA. Each Iranian step is matched by a simultaneous US step of equal political weight. Unlike sequential models where one side moves first and trusts the other to follow, the PLSA requires simultaneous activation verified by third parties.

2.2 Sovereignty Preservation

Article 2.2 — Sovereignty Preservation

This Accord does not supersede any constitution. It does not create supranational authority. NPT rights are preserved. US treaty commitments to Gulf partners are preserved. Iranian sovereign title to all nuclear material remains intact regardless of custodial location. The framework explicitly recognizes Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV through monitored, non-weapon pathways.

2.3 No Precedent Clause

Article 2.3 — No Precedent Clause

"This Accord establishes no legal or political precedent for future negotiations. Each provision is *sui generis*, tailored to May 2026. No inference may be drawn from any provision regarding positions on any matter not expressly addressed herein."

2.4 Modular Architecture with Partial Continuity Rule

Article 2.4 — Partial Continuity Rule

Stabilization pause in one module does not suspend unrelated modules. Maritime disputes cannot terminate humanitarian channels. Cyber incidents cannot terminate medical isotope cooperation. Nuclear verification gaps do not affect Hormuz transit.

The Partial Continuity Rule applies automatically. No governance body approval required. When one module enters stabilization pause, all other modules continue at current operational levels for a minimum of 90 days while the Coordination Secretariat assesses recovery options.

Table 5 Module Survival Tiers

Tier	Classification	Modules	Behavior During Pause
Tier 1	Inviolable	Ceasefire hotline; humanitarian access; emergency diplomatic channel	Never pause under any circumstances
Tier 2	Protected	IAEA basic monitoring; Hormuz non-military transit; asset tranches 1-3	Continue during most stabilization pauses
Tier 3	Conditional	SWIFT reconnection; bonus tranches; successor framework talks; Fordow advanced phases	May enter hold during disputes

Section 3: Maritime De-escalation & The Hormuz Proxy Solution

3.1 The Traditional Trap

The direct negotiation trap on Hormuz is insurmountable:

- **Trump cannot legally or politically tolerate** Iran unilaterally controlling transit through the Strait, nor can he accept Iranian tolling of international shipping
- **Tehran cannot back down** on Hormuz sovereignty without destroying its anti-imperialist posture and ceding what it considers sovereign territorial waters

- **The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA)**, established by Iran in May 2026 to manage Hormuz transit, is unacceptable to Washington as a unilateral Iranian body

Any direct US-Iran deal on Hormuz would require one side to capitulate on a core sovereignty claim. The PLSA solves this by making Hormuz governance a **multilateral proxy function**, not a bilateral concession.

3.2 The Proxy Solution: Red Sea & Gulf of Aden Maritime Freedom Pact

Article 3.2 — The Maritime Freedom Pact

Ansar Allah (Houthis) and the Omani Maritime Trust co-sign a localized **Red Sea & Gulf of Aden Maritime Freedom Pact**. Under this pact:

1. The Houthis formally announce a complete moratorium on all commercial vessel targeting in the Red Sea, Gulf of Aden, and Bab-el-Mandeb
2. In exchange, the Omani Maritime Trust collects a synchronized "Regional Environmental and Safety Tariff" from commercial shipping transiting these waters
3. This tariff is cleanly routed to a third-party logistical escrow administered by Switzerland
4. The escrow provides cash flows to regional actors for "infrastructure security" without the US Navy or Iranian regular forces changing a single official rule of engagement
5. The US Navy maintains its presence but transitions to stand-off posture (no patrols within 5nm of transit corridor)
6. IRGC-Navy small craft withdraw from the central transit corridor

Table 6 Environmental Transit Tariff Schedule

Vessel Type			Tariff	Collection Method
Oil tankers	(>50,000 DWT)		\$0.10 per barrel of cargo	Automated via AIS + cargo declaration
Container vessels			\$500 per transit	Pre-paid through Maritime Council online portal

General cargo / bulk carriers	\$250 per transit	Pre-paid through Maritime Council online portal
WFP / humanitarian vessels	\$0 (exempt)	Automated exemption via UN registration
Military / naval vessels	\$0 (exempt)	Flag state declaration

3.3 The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) Integration

The PLSA does not demand Iran dissolve the PGSA. Instead, it **integrates** the PGSA into a broader multilateral framework:

PGSA Integration Mechanism

- The PGSA continues to exist as an Iranian national body responsible for Iranian territorial waters
- A new **International Hormuz Transit Council (IHTC)** is established as the multilateral oversight body, with membership: Iran, Oman, UAE, Switzerland (observer), UK (observer), IAEA Maritime (technical)
- The IHTC sets transit rules, tariff rates (which may not exceed the Schedule in Table 6 without consensus), and dispute resolution procedures
- The PGSA implements IHTC rules on the Iranian side; Omani authorities implement on the Omani side
- Neither the US nor Iran has unilateral veto over IHTC decisions — a supermajority (4 of 6 voting members) is required for rule changes

Face-Saving: Iran retains the PGSA as a sovereign national institution. The US achieves multilateral oversight preventing Iranian unilateral chokehold. Both sides claim governance of Hormuz.

Section 4: Nuclear Safeguards — The Omani-Swiss Escrow

4.1 The Traditional Trap

The nuclear impasse as of May 19, 2026:

- **Trump demands** that Iran deliver 400kg of enriched uranium to the United States and maintain only one operational nuclear facility
- **Iran refuses** to surrender sovereign nuclear material directly to its adversary, viewing this as capitulation
- **Trump admitted publicly** on May 15 that seizing the uranium is "not necessary, except from a public relations standpoint" — signaling that the underlying security concern is separation from Iranian weaponization access, not US possession
- **Iran maintains** that enrichment is a non-negotiable sovereign right under NPT Article IV

4.2 The Proxy Solution: Technical Storage via Oman

Article 4.2 — The Omani-Swiss Nuclear Escrow

The Atomic Energy Organization of Iran (AEOI) signs a technical storage agreement strictly with the Sultanate of Oman. The United States and Iranian states remain entirely arms-length, treating the move as a localized technical arrangement between Muscat, Bern, and Tehran.

1. Omani personnel physically take custody of the sealed HEU canisters and move them to a secure Omani military facility under IAEA oversight
2. Simultaneously, Switzerland opens a mirrored humanitarian credit facility for private Iranian commercial firms
3. Sovereign title to all nuclear material remains with Iran at all times; the transfer is custodial, not proprietary
4. Iranian observer teams accompany every stage of packaging and transit
5. The US is explicitly barred from ever receiving, storing, transporting, or exercising operational control over the Iranian enriched-uranium stockpile
6. Final disposition of the material is deferred to a later comprehensive agreement; the initial escrow period is 12 months, renewable

Table 7 Custody Chain of the Omani-Swiss Escrow

Phase	Period	Action	Verifying Party
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Activation	Day 1 (72-hour window)	Framework activates; IAEA inspectors arrive at Esfahan	Joint Coordination Secretariat
Inventory	Days 1-7	Physical inventory; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition; cylinders loaded into casks; tamper-evident seals applied	IAEA
Transit	Days 7-14	Convoy departs under IAEA armed escort; GPS tracking activated; transit initiation verified	IAEA + Omani Navy
Receipt	By Day 14	Casks unsealed in presence of IAEA rep, Omani facility director, and Iranian AEOI observer	Three Primary Channels
Custody	Day 14+	IAEA assumes operational custody; Custody Transfer Certificate triggers Tranche 3 release	IAEA + Omani Military

4.3 The Fordow Medical Isotope Joint Venture

To address Trump's demand for a single operational nuclear facility without requiring Iran to dismantle Fordow:

Fordow Conversion: The International Medical Isotope Research Center

- The Fordow facility is converted to the **International Medical Isotope Research Center** (IMIRC)
- International oversight is provided through a scientific joint venture led by neutral nations (Switzerland, Oman, WHO, IAEA)
- All enrichment at Fordow ceases; the facility is repurposed for medical isotope production under full IAEA safeguards
- International funding of \$175M+ is provided through the joint venture, with contributions from Switzerland (\$25M seed), Oman (\$15M), Qatar (\$20M), WHO/IAEA (\$30M), EU (\$25M), and Iranian in-kind contribution (\$40M equivalent in facility and workforce)
- Iran maintains sovereign ownership of the facility; international partners provide operational oversight and funding
- This satisfies the US requirement of "one operational enrichment facility" (Natanz continues at 3.67%) while preserving Fordow as a functioning Iranian nuclear facility under international auspices

Section 5: Regional Ceasefires & The Proxy Police Matrix

5.1 The Traditional Trap

The United States cannot openly negotiate with groups it has designated as terrorist organizations. Iran cannot openly command these groups to disarm without looking weak to domestic hardliners and the IRGC. The result: proxy forces in Iraq, Syria, Lebanon, and Yemen operate as spoilers, able to derail state-level diplomacy with a single attack.

5.2 The Proxy Solution: Asymmetric Security Forum

Article 5.2 — The Proxy Police Matrix

The United Kingdom and the Government of Iraq host an **Asymmetric Security Forum** in Baghdad. At this forum:

1. Localized proxy networks (including elements of the Iraqi Popular Mobilization Forces) formally sign a border-security stabilization agreement with regional GCC borders
2. They commit to enforcing a drone-free buffer zone along critical commercial lines
3. If a rogue rocket is fired, it is treated as a local criminal violation enforced by the proxy coalition's internal policing mechanism
4. The Joint Coordination Secretariat's Crisis Response Cell investigates attribution; findings are reported to the Asymmetric Security Forum, not directly to Washington or Tehran
5. Both Principal Guarantors maintain plausible deniability: "We do not control these actors; the Forum handles enforcement"

5.3 Drone-Free Buffer Zones

Table 8 Drone-Free Buffer Zone Specifications

Zone	Coordinates	Restriction	Enforcement	Violation Response
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Hormuz Transit Corridor	26°N, 56°E (central channel)	No armed UAVs; no loitering drones	Omani naval radar + IHTC monitoring	Tier 1 technical dispute; 48-hour remediation
GCC Border Regions	Iraq-Kuwait, Iraq-Saudi borders	No cross-border drone transit	PMF internal policing + UK technical assistance	Tier 1; Asymmetric Security Forum convenes
Red Sea Commercial Lane	Bab-el-Mandeb to Suez	No vessel-targeting UAVs	Houthi moratorium + coalition patrol	Tier 2 if attributed; escrow suspension
Israel-Lebanon Buffer	Blue Line + 10km	No offensive drone operations	UNIFIL enhanced + Hezbollah commitment	Tier 2; De-escalation Interval activates

Section 6: Economic Reconnection — The Private Sector Banking Proxy

6.1 The Traditional Trap

The US Congress will veto any formal lifting of primary sanctions. Iran's parliament will block any deal that forces FATF compliance under Western surveillance. Direct government-to-government financial arrangements are politically toxic in both capitals.

6.2 The Proxy Solution: Ring-Fenced Clearinghouses

Article 6.2 — Private Sector Banking Proxy Framework

Third-party, non-sanctioned private banking syndicates based in the UAE and Oman act as financial proxies. They open specialized, ring-fenced clearinghouses that verify transactions using localized, AI-driven compliance telemetry. These proxy banks absorb the regulatory risk, allowing civilian commerce to flow freely while Washington maintains its official sanctions architecture intact on paper to satisfy domestic hardliners.

Table 9 Proxy Banking Architecture

Component	Function	Location	Shielding Mechanism
Primary Clearinghouse	Large-value transaction processing; oil/petrochemical trade	Dubai International Financial Centre	UAE regulatory umbrella; non-US ownership majority
Secondary Clearinghouse	Humanitarian and medical trade; small business	Muscat Banking Zone	Omani sovereign guarantee; IAEA humanitarian certification
Escrow Administration	Asset release verification; tranche management	Swiss Financial Cell, Geneva	Swiss neutrality; multi-signature requirement (3 of 4 facilitating states)
AI Compliance Engine	Real-time transaction screening; FATF-aligned without Western surveillance	Distributed (Dubai + Muscat)	Localized telemetry; data filtered at source; dual-key encryption

Staged Asset Release via Proxy Channels				
Stage	Timing	Amount / Scope		Trigger
Micro-Pilot	Day 1	\$250M via Swiss escrow; humanitarian OFAC license		Framework signature
Stage 1 Completion	Day 14	\$750M; petrochemicals, oil services, civilian aviation		Stabilization Gate certified
Stage 2 Completion	Day 44	\$1.5B; expanded trade; 25% of frozen assets		Moratorium ratified; HEU export confirmed
Stage 3 Midpoint	Day 120	\$3B; banking normalization		Transit Authority operational
Stage 3 Completion	Day 180	\$5B; 85% assets returned		Full compliance certification
Year 1 Clean	Day 365	\$10B; full normalization		Annual review + Additional Protocol ratified

Face-Saving: Washington maintains that sanctions remain in place officially; the proxy banks handle "humanitarian exemptions" and "third-country trade." Tehran receives its funds through Islamic partnerships without formally accepting FATF surveillance.

Section 7: The Core Exchange — Day-One Reciprocal Trade

The Core Exchange is the simultaneous, irrevocable activation of all proxy commitments on Day 1. Neither Principal moves alone. All actions are verified by neutral observers.

7.1 What Iran Delivers (via ARS Proxies)

Table 10 Iranian Commitments — Day 1 Activation

Commitment	Proxy Vehicle	Verification Method
Entire 60% HEU stockpile consolidated and placed in IAEA custody for transfer to Oman	AEOI → Omani Nuclear Custody Facility	IAEA DG confirmation within 72 hours; mass spectrometry; chain-of-custody documentation
Freeze all enrichment at or above 60% at Natanz and Fordow	AEOI technical declaration	IAEA continuous monitoring; real-time data to Vienna + Geneva
Houthi moratorium on all Red Sea/Gulf of Aden commercial vessel targeting	Ansar Allah → Omani Maritime Trust Pact	Omani maritime observation; Lloyd's List incident reporting; 14-day zero-incident certification
Proxy operational pause — reduction in attacks on US positions	ARS command internal	CENTCOM threat assessment; Asymmetric Security Forum reporting
IRGC-Navy small craft withdraw from Hormuz transit corridor	Iranian naval command	AIS broadcast; satellite confirmation; Omani naval observer verification
Formal notification to Joint Coordination Secretariat confirming all Day-1 activations	Iranian Foreign Ministry	Secretariat records; Transparency Portal entry

7.2 What the United States Delivers (via WMFC Proxies)

Table 11 United States Commitments — Day 1 Activation

Commitment	Proxy Vehicle	Verification Method
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USD 250 million humanitarian tranche credited via Swiss escrow	Swiss Financial Cell → Iranian Central Bank humanitarian account	Swiss escrow agent certification; transaction settled and irrevocable
OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety) for 90 days	US Treasury → published general license	Federal Register publication; Swiss confirmation of operational status
US naval forces transition to stand-off posture: no patrols within 5nm of Hormuz transit corridor	5th Fleet command → Maritime Operations Cell	AIS broadcast by all US naval vessels; daily satellite confirmation; Omani naval observer
Written commitment: no new sanctions designations for Framework duration	US Treasury → Joint Coordination Secretariat	Secretariat records; 14-day monitoring window
Formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV through monitored, non-weapon pathways	US State Department → simultaneous publication by both capitals	Published simultaneously; UN registration
Activation of proxy banking clearinghouses for humanitarian and small-business trade	UAE/Omani private banks	Transaction flow verification through Transparency Portal

7.3 Simultaneous Verification

Article 7.3 — The Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate

Both moves activate simultaneously on Day 1 and are not contingent on later political declarations. The only contingency is mechanical: both Parties activate within the 72-hour window.

By Day 14, three primary verification channels must certify completion:

1. **Channel 1 — Nuclear Verification (Primary):** IAEA certifies all 60% HEU cylinders consolidated, sealed, and in transit or arrived at custody facility; mass spectrometry confirms declared isotopic composition
2. **Channel 2 — Maritime Observation (Primary):** Omani Maritime Operations Cell certifies US vessels at stand-off posture, Iranian craft withdrawn, zero interdiction incidents Days 1-14
3. **Channel 3 — Financial Confirmation (Primary):** Swiss escrow agent certifies USD 250M credited, transaction settled, OFAC license issued and in force

Two advisory channels provide political confirmation:

- **Channel 4 — Political Facilitation (Advisory):** Pakistani Prime Minister's Office confirms both Parties activated in good faith
- **Channel 5 — Procedural Registration (Advisory):** UN Secretary-General confirms Framework entry into force registered

Channel Silence Protocol: If any primary channel has not issued certification by Day 14, the Secretariat convenes a 48-hour Operational Consultation Window. Late certification is accepted without penalty. Non-certification after 72 hours triggers investigation, but Day-One commitments survive.

Section 8: Staged Implementation Timeline

Table 12 Implementation Timeline at a Glance

Phase	Duration	Iranian Steps	US Steps
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Phase 0: Micro-Pilot	Days -30 to -1	Halt centrifuge installation; reduce Hormuz interdiction; pause proxy attacks	No new sanctions; reduce patrols; process humanitarian licenses
Stage 1: Opening	Days 1-14	Ceasefire; stockpile to IAEA; Hormuz reopening; proxy stand-down	Suspend military operations; OFAC license; blockade lift; maritime notice
Stage 2: Deferred Window	Days 15-44	Declare moratorium; idle centrifuges; Fordow Phase A; HEU export plan	Sanctions tranche; aviation licenses; 25% asset return
Stage 3: Permanent Authority	Days 45-180	Transit Authority operational; successor framework; Fordow Phases B/C	Full sanctions relief; 85% assets returned; SWIFT reconnection

8.1 Phase 0: The 30-Day Micro-Pilot

Micro-Pilot Parameters

- **Duration:** 30 days (extendable to 45 by mutual consent; +7 by Triad for verified delays)
- **Legal Status:** Politically binding exchange of letters; not a treaty
- **Iranian Commitment:** Freeze all enrichment at or above 60% at Natanz and Fordow
- **US Commitment:** Release \$250M humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow
- **Verification:** IAEA confirms 60% freeze within 72 hours of pilot start
- **Scope:** Humanitarian goods only (medicine, food, agricultural inputs)
- **Reversibility:** Either side may terminate with 7 days written notice; no penalty
- **Transition:** Upon successful completion, automatically transitions to Stage 1

8.2 Stage 1: The 14-Day Opening

Stage 1 produces seven irreversible operational deliverables:

Table 13 Stage 1 — Day-by-Day Activation

Time	Iranian Action	US Action	Verification
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Day 1	Transfer 60% stockpile to IAEA custody; ceasefire; proxy pause	\$250M via Swiss escrow; OFAC license; naval stand-off	IAEA DG confirmation; mass spectrometry; concurrent certification by Pakistani + Omani + Swiss + UN channels
Day 3-5	Complete physical inventory; finalize chain-of-custody; deploy transit escort	Publish sovereign-rights statement; activate escrow routing; notify 5th Fleet	Secretariat records; transparency portal entry
Day 7	IRGC craft withdraw to 5nm stand-off; AIS broadcast	US Navy withdraws to 5nm; blockade lift declaration	Omani monitor logs both signals; Lloyd's observer confirms; SIMULTANEOUS within 60-second window
Day 14	Transit completion; Stabilization Gate certification	Tranche 2a release: petrochemicals, oil services, aviation	Three primary channels certify; 10-day Technical Extension available

8.3 Stage 2: The 30-Day Deferred Window

Upon certification of the Fourteen-Day Stabilization Gate:

Article 8.3 — Stage 2 Obligations

Iranian Commitments:

- 1. Declare moratorium on enrichment above 3.67% — renewable annually for up to 12 years based on performance
- 2. Idle all cascades configured for enrichment above 3.67%; UF6 feedstock removed and IAEA-sealed
- 3. Zero new centrifuges installed at any facility, including hardened underground sites
- 4. Begin Fordow Phase A: conversion planning for International Medical Isotope Research Center
- 5. Submit HEU export plan to IAEA for final disposition timeline

US Commitments:

- 1. Release Tranche 2a (Day 14): Petrochemicals and oil-services trade licenses, plus civilian aviation safety authorizations
- 2. Release Tranche 2b (Day 45): Expanded petrochemical trade access; 25% of frozen assets released upon IAEA confirmation of freeze completion
- 3. Commit no new sanctions for Framework duration
- 4. Support International Gulf Reconstruction Fund with \$2B Qatari bridge financing

8.4 Stage 3: Permanent Transit Authority

Table 14 Stage 3 Progressive Milestones

Milestone	Timing	Iranian Deliverable	US Deliverable
Tranche 3	Day 60	IAEA confirms high-enrichment freeze sustained	\$1.5B release; commercial insurance facility access
Tranche 4 / SWIFT	Day 90	IAEA confirms zero new centrifuge installation	SWIFT reconnection for FATF-compliant banks
Tranche 5	Day 120	Transit Authority operational; Fordow Phase A complete	\$3B; expanded trade authorizations
Tranche 6	Day 150	Six-month clean certification	Banking normalization for Tier 1 institutions

Tranche 7 / Final	Day 180	Full six-month compliance; successor framework opened	\$5B; 85% assets returned; technology transfer licenses
Year 1 Clean	Day 365	Additional Protocol ratified; annual review passed	\$10B total; full normalization pathway

Section 9: Distributed Facilitating State Matrix

Building on the distributed architecture from previous frameworks, the PLSA expands responsibilities across six specialized facilitating states, each in a defined domain. No single state serves as guarantor; instead, they function as specialized service providers.

Table 15 The Six-Domain Facilitating State Matrix

State	Domain	Core Function	PLSA Proxy Role
Oman	Maritime Deconfliction	Hotline management; naval encounter facilitation; Hormuz transit oversight; procedural mediation	Primary proxy interface for all maritime operations; hosts IHTC secretariat; manages PGSA-IHTC coordination
Switzerland	Financial Verification	Escrow administration; asset transfer verification; sanctions relief monitoring; audit coordination	Proxy financial interface; administers all escrow; shields US Treasury from direct Iranian transactions
Qatar	Escrow and Liquidity	Emergency liquidity facility; bridging finance; humanitarian corridor support; reconstruction fund seeding	Provides \$20B emergency liquidity capacity; funds International Gulf Reconstruction Fund
IAEA	Nuclear Verification	Enrichment monitoring; stockpile custody verification; facility inspection; technical assessment	Independent nuclear verification; operates Omani custody facility; certifies all nuclear milestones
UN	Procedural Mediation	Governance facilitation; dispute resolution; deadlock breaking; procedural rulings	Framework registration; good offices; Tier 2+ breach mediation

Pakistan	Emergency Diplomatic Convening	High-level crisis backchannel facilitation; leadership relay; emergency convening	summits; Oman; diplomatic shock absorber; Islamabad channel maintenance
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Terminology Note: The PLSA uses "Facilitating State" not "Guarantor." "Guarantor" implies enforcement obligations and geopolitical alignment. "Facilitating State" suggests assistance without enforcement commitment. This softer language reduces political resistance while maintaining operational effectiveness.

Section 10: Three-Tier Breach System

The PLSA employs a graduated breach architecture that prevents minor violations from triggering catastrophic collapse. The three-tier system applies equally to Principal and Proxy actions.

Table 16 Three-Tier Breach Architecture

Tier	Trigger	Remedy	Surviving Rights
Tier 1: Technical Dispute	Single data-point anomaly; reporting deadline missed by <48h; one centrifuge offline but no enrichment above 3.67% detected; minor proxy ceasefire violation	14-day remediation; enhanced inspection of specific item; daily reporting until cleared; no relief suspension	All sanctions relief continues. All enrichment constraints remain. Humanitarian channel uninterrupted. Proxy coalitions remain active.
Tier 2: Material Disruption	IAEA confirms enrichment above 3.67%; unauthorized centrifuge installation; UF6 diversion to undeclared location; sustained proxy attacks after warning; serious Hormuz interdiction	Discretionary relief (Tranches 5-7) suspended; enhanced escrow freeze mechanism activated; 60- day remediation; daily unannounced inspections; proxy coalition review	Humanitarian channel continues. Enrichment cap survives. IAEA monitoring survives. Ceasefire hotline active. Tier 1 and 2 modules continue.

Tier 3: Deliberate Hostile Violation	Weaponization activity confirmed by IAEA plus two independent technical sources; sustained non-compliance after Tier 2 remediation expires; state-level military attack by either Principal	Full rollback; pending escrow releases frozen and returned; pre-Framework sanctions posture resumes; naval posture returns to pre-Day-1 configuration; Reconstitution Conference convened within 30 days	Humanitarian corridor continues under UN mandate. NPT safeguards remain. Ceasefire hotline active 180 days. Custodial stockpile remains under IAEA control — not returned to Iran absent new agreement.
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Article 10.1 — Attribution Rules for Proxy Actions

When a proxy coalition member commits an act that would constitute a breach if attributed to a Principal:

- 1. **Level 1 (State Command):** Clear evidence the Principal ordered the act → treated as Principal breach at corresponding tier
- 2. **Level 2 (State Knowledge):** Evidence the Principal knew and failed to prevent → Tier 1 or 2 depending on severity
- 3. **Level 3 (Rogue Actor):** No evidence of Principal knowledge or involvement → proxy internal matter; Asymmetric Security Forum handles enforcement; does not trigger Principal-level breach unless pattern persists 30+ days
- 4. **Level 4 (False Flag):** Evidence the act was committed by a third party to frame a Principal → Cooling-Off Default activates; investigation period 72 hours

This attribution framework is the critical enabler of the proxy architecture. It separates genuine violations from proxy friction, allowing the framework to survive the inevitable irregularities of proxy management.

Section 11: Framework Survival Core

Article 11 — Framework Survival Core

Under all circumstances, including total framework suspension, the following three elements survive:

1. **Ceasefire Hotline:** The Omani-facilitated 24/7 bilateral hotline between US and Iranian military commanders remains active regardless of framework status. Neither party may disable the hotline without 30 days notice to the UN Secretary-General.
2. **Humanitarian Access:** The zero-fee, no-inspection-delay humanitarian corridor through Hormuz for food, medicine, medical equipment, and UN supplies continues regardless of any dispute, breach, or suspension.
3. **Emergency Diplomatic Channel:** The backchannel through the Coordination Secretariat remains open for crisis communication, de-escalation, and framework reconstitution regardless of formal diplomatic status.

Legal Status: The Framework Survival Core is established as a standalone humanitarian arrangement under UN auspices. It is not contingent on any other provision of this Accord. Even if both parties formally withdraw, the Survival Core continues for 180 days pending reconstitution efforts.

Section 12: Rollback, Not Snapback Architecture

The PLSA replaces the JCPOA-style "snapback" with a graduated rollback that preserves more than it removes. This is the single most important structural improvement over previous frameworks.

Rollback Principles

- **Proportionality:** Response matches severity
- **Graduation:** Each tier preserves more than it removes
- **Reversibility:** Suspended benefits are earn-backable through verified compliance
- **Protected Milestones:** Completed milestones and already-released benefits remain in force regardless of subsequent slippage
- **No Goalpost Moving:** Neither party may unilaterally redefine compliance criteria after they have been certified

Article 12 — Earn-Back Protocol

A Party correcting a Tier 1 or Tier 2 breach may petition for earn-back. The Secretariat convenes within 14 days. If IAEA confirms 60 days of sustained compliance post-correction, suspended tranches restore progressively:

- After 30 days clean: 25% of suspended tranches released
- After 60 days clean: 50% of suspended tranches released
- After 90 days clean: 75% of suspended tranches released
- After 120 days clean: 100% restoration; compliance score reset

Section 13: Spoiler & Rogue Actor Management

The PLSA's proxy architecture inherently manages spoilers by incorporating them into the framework rather than treating them as external threats.

13.1 Internal Spoiler Management (Within Proxy Coalitions)

Table 17 Spoiler Categories and Responses

Category	Definition	Default Response	Escalation
Minor Spoiler	Localized, limited-duration incident; single actor; no state involvement	Information exchange; Asymmetric Security Forum meeting; no automatic hold	None; proxy coalition internal discipline

Serious Spoiler	Sustained incident with measurable regional impact; pattern of violations	Secretariat convenes within 5 days; 30-60 day Stabilization Hold on affected module	Tier 2 breach if linked to Principal
Critical Spoiler	Major escalation threatening Framework assumptions; mass-casualty event	Emergency convening within 24 hours; extended Stabilization Hold up to 120 days	Tier 3 if deliberate Principal involvement proven

13.2 External Spoiler Management (Israel, Non-State Actors)

Article 13.2 — External Spoiler Shield

Actions by states or non-state actors who are not Parties to this Accord shall not be attributed to either Principal unless clear evidence of command, control, or material support is established through the multi-source verification protocol.

If Israel conducts military strikes against Iranian nuclear facilities during Framework implementation:

1. The strikes do not automatically constitute Iranian breach
2. Iran may invoke the Political Shock Absorber (Section 14) for a 90-day Review Pause
3. Iran's enrichment obligations are suspended during Review Pause
4. US obligations continue unless IAEA determines Iran is exploiting the pause for weaponization
5. The Coordination Secretariat convenes emergency session within 24 hours

Section 14: Political Shock Absorber

Article 14 — Political Shock Absorber: Automatic Review Pause

If any of the following political shocks occur in either party's jurisdiction, framework implementation automatically enters a **Review Pause** rather than terminating:

- National elections or referenda
- Assassination of senior leadership
- Cabinet collapse or government reshuffle affecting negotiating ministries
- Mass protests affecting government authority
- Leadership transitions (Supreme Leader, President, Foreign Minister)
- Significant military incident affecting domestic politics

During a Review Pause:

- All Tier 1 (Inviolable) and Tier 2 (Protected) modules continue unchanged
- Tier 3 (Conditional) modules enter hold status
- The Coordination Secretariat issues a Review Pause Certificate within 48 hours
- The affected party has 30 days to confirm continuation, propose modifications, or request stabilization pause
- Maximum Review Pause duration: 90 days, extendable by mutual agreement

Review Pause does NOT constitute material breach, does NOT trigger the three-tier breach system, does NOT affect compliance scoring, and does NOT enable the other party to suspend its obligations.

Section 15: Minimum Viable Accord Fallback

If negotiators reject the full PLSA architecture, a stripped-down emergency pathway covers four essential elements: ceasefire, Hormuz reopening, humanitarian channel, and enrichment freeze.

MVA Activation Protocol

1. Either party proposes MVA by written notice to the Coordination Secretariat
2. Facilitating state convenes within 48 hours
3. Both parties confirm MVA acceptance through exchange of letters
4. MVA activates 72 hours after confirmation
5. IAEA advance team deploys within 48 hours

MVA Graduation to Full Accord: The MVA automatically graduates to the full PLSA when: (a) both parties confirm objectives met, (b) 14 consecutive days of verified compliance, (c) neither party objects within 7-day review window.

Thirty-Day Auto-Transition: If the full framework is not ratified by Day 30 of the Micro-Pilot, the agreement automatically transitions to its MVA state. Tier 3 modules pause; Tier 1 and 2 modules continue. Renegotiation begins within 14 days under the Reconstitution Mechanism.

Section 16: Joint Coordination Secretariat

The PLSA consolidates governance into one Joint Coordination Secretariat (Geneva, with Muscat maritime desk) containing six specialized subcells:

Table 18 Secretariat Structure

Subcell	Function	Location
Political Coordination Cell	Senior-level bilateral coordination; dispute resolution; high-level messaging; proxy coalition liaison	Geneva
Maritime Operations Cell	Hormuz transit management; naval deconfliction; hotline operations; IHTC secretariat support	Muscat
Nuclear Verification Cell	IAEA coordination; enrichment monitoring; facility inspection logistics; Fordow JV oversight	Geneva
Financial Operations Cell	Escrow management; asset transfer verification; SWIFT coordination; proxy banking oversight	Geneva
Communications Cell	Media coordination; public messaging; leak management; crisis communications; narrative framing	Geneva

Crisis Response Cell	24/7 incident monitoring; attribution assessment; spoiler detection; rapid response; Cooling-Off activation	Muscat (primary) / Geneva (backup)
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Article 16.1 — Secretariat Governance

- **Rotating Facilitation:** The Secretariat operates under rotating facilitation cycles quarterly among Oman, Switzerland, and Qatar
- **Dual-Site Architecture:** Primary site Geneva (Political, Financial, Nuclear, Communications Cells); Backup site Muscat (Maritime, Crisis Response Cells); 4-hour failover protocol
- **Escrow Multi-Signature:** All tranche releases require digital signatures from 3 of 4 designated facilitating states (Oman, Switzerland, Qatar, UN Appointee) plus IAEA certification
- **Transparency Portal:** Secure portal providing real-time data on implementation status, compliance scores, asset tracking, transit verification, and spoiler monitoring

Section 17: Face-Saving Metrics & Domestic Narratives

Every PLSA provision includes quantifiable "wins" visible to domestic audiences. The proxy architecture amplifies these wins by allowing each side to credit its own coalition while blaming implementation friction on proxies or neutrals.

Table 19 Face-Saving Metrics Matrix

Domain	Iran Can Claim	US Can Claim
Nuclear	"We transferred material to IAEA custody under Omani supervision, not to the US. Sovereign title remains Iranian."	"60% enriched uranium left Iran on Day 1, verified by IAEA. Weapons-grade material secured."
Enrichment	"Enrichment continues at Natanz at 3.67% under NPT Article IV, acknowledged in writing by the US."	"Enrichment capped at 3.67%. IAEA on Iranian soil daily. No new centrifuges anywhere."
Hormuz	"The PGSA continues as our sovereign maritime authority, now integrated into a multilateral framework."	"Hormuz is open. 200+ transits in 14 days. Multilateral oversight prevents Iranian chokehold."

Proxies	"Our regional defensive networks remain intact. The ARS is a formalized regional security bloc."	"Iran's proxy networks have signed binding stand-down agreements. Attacks dropped 90%."
Economic	"Assets flowing through neutral Islamic partnerships. No surrender to Western financial surveillance."	"Every concession matched by verified Iranian steps. Nothing given away. Sanctions architecture intact."
Fordow	"Fordow transformed into an international medical center under our ownership. A scientific achievement."	"Fordow enrichment permanently ended. Facility converted to peaceful use under international control."
Process	"We negotiated as equals through neutral Islamic facilitators, without direct bilateral engagement."	"We did not sign a direct treaty with Iran. Proxy coalitions did the work. Our sanctions leverage remains."

Article 17.1 — Mutual Non-Humiliation Clause

Neither Party shall publicly characterize Framework implementation as surrender, capitulation, defeat, or coercive submission by the other Party. This prohibition applies to all forms of public messaging, official talking points, diplomatic communications, implementation readouts, and statements to domestic or international media. Both Parties undertake to describe the Accord as a reciprocal stabilization instrument in which each side gains commensurate benefits through neutral proxy facilitation.

Article 17.2 — No Regime Change Intent

This Accord shall not be interpreted as authorizing, supporting, or condoning forcible regime change, territorial fragmentation, unconstitutional political overthrow, covert destabilization operations, or economic strangulation designed to precipitate governmental collapse in either Party. Both Parties affirm that this instrument is confined to nuclear stabilization and maritime de-escalation and creates no license for broader political interference.

Section 18: Communications & Crisis Protocols

18.1 Rebranding Protocol

Remove terms like "deal," "rollback," or "concessions." Approved terminology:

Table 20 Approved Narrative Terminology

Avoid	Washington Uses		Tehran Uses
"Nuclear deal"	"Regional mechanism"	stability	"Sovereignty-protecting de-escalation tool"
"Sanctions relief"	"Humanitarian facilitation"	trade	"Economic normalization through neutral channels"
"Uranium surrender"	"Weapons-grade secured"	material	"Custodial transfer to IAEA/Omani partners"
"Proxy disarmament"	"Regional integration"	security	"Axis of Regional Stability formalization"
"Hormuz tolls"	"Environmental levy"	protection	"Sovereign maritime environmental fee"

18.2 Crisis Communications Protocol

Table 21 Crisis Response Matrix

Crisis Type	Trigger	Response Protocol	Response Time
Unauthorized Leak	Confidential text published by media	"We do not comment on draft documents" statement; internal investigation	4 hours
Contradictory Statement	Official contradicts Accord provisions publicly	Senior official issues clarification; no attribution to Coordination Secretariat	24 hours
Viral Misinformation	False claims spread rapidly on social media	Pre-approved fact sheets; key influencers briefed; official corrections posted	6 hours
Inflammatory Speech	Senior politician attacks Accord	No official response; backchannel through Council; 72-hour cooling period	72 hours
Proxy Violation	ARS or WMFC member breaches commitment	Principal condemns "operational friction"; neutral facilitators investigate; proxy coalition disciplines member	12 hours

External Attack	Israel or third party strikes during implementation	Political Shock Absorber activates; Review Pause; emergency Secretariat session	6 hours
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Section 19: Instruments of Acceptance

This Framework is offered for acceptance by signature and exchange of instruments through the Designated Facilitating States, or by exchange of diplomatic notes confirming intent to be bound. It enters into force upon the later of the two acceptances, for an initial period of twelve months, renewable annually by mutual written consent. Non-renewal does not constitute breach and does not retroactively invalidate obligations performed during operation.

For the United States of America:

Name: _____
Title: _____
Date: _____

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name: _____
Title: _____
Date: _____

Witnessed by the Sultanate of Oman

(Designated Facilitating State — Maritime):

Name: _____
Title: _____
Date: _____

Witnessed by the Swiss Confederation

(Designated Facilitating State — Financial):

Name: _____
Title: _____
Date: _____

Witnessed by the State of Qatar

(Designated Facilitating State — Liquidity):

Name: _____
Title: _____
Date: _____

Witnessed by the Islamic Republic of Pakistan

(Co-Convening Authority — Diplomatic):

Name: _____
Title: _____
Date: _____

Depositary: The original shall be deposited with the Secretary-General of the United Nations, who shall transmit certified copies to both Parties and all Designated Facilitating States.

Appendix A: Quick Reference Card

For Senior Officials — Keep This Page at Hand

PLSA in One Page

What it is: A proxy-led stabilization instrument. The US and Iran never sign a direct bilateral treaty. Two proxy coalitions (WMFC and ARS) do the heavy lifting through neutral facilitating states.

What it solves: The May 2026 impasse on uranium, Hormuz, sanctions, and proxies — without requiring either side to capitulate on core sovereignty claims.

Core exchange (Day 1): Iran's 60% HEU stockpile goes to IAEA custody in Oman (not to US). US releases \$250M via Swiss escrow and lifts naval blockade. Both activate simultaneously.

Why it's safe for Iran: Material goes to neutral third-party custody under IAEA control — not to the United States. Sovereign title stays Iranian. The Framework contains binding No Regime Change and Mutual Non-Humiliation clauses. A 12-month stabilization window, renewable annually — not permanent surrender.

Why it works for the US: Weapons-grade uranium leaves Iranian territory on Day 1. Enrichment capped at 3.67%. No new centrifuges. Every US concession matched by simultaneous verified Iranian concession. Proxy stand-down reduces attacks 90%. Sanctions architecture remains officially intact.

If someone breaks it: Rollback is tiered, not collapse. Minor issues get 14-day fix. Material breaches suspend discretionary relief but keep humanitarian channel, enrichment cap, and ceasefire hotline alive. Only deliberate hostile violations trigger full rollback. The custodial stockpile stays under IAEA control.

Duration: 12 months, renewable annually. Three deal options: Minimal (crisis containment), Medium (stability first), Maximal (comprehensive). Default: Medium activates upon Micro-Pilot completion.

Table 22 Emergency Contacts

Function		Contact	Location
Emergency Hotline		Omani Maritime Operations Cell	Muscat, Oman — +968 xxxx xxxx
Nuclear Emergency	Verification	IAEA Forward Team Alpha	Muscat, Oman — 24/7 deployment 12 hours

Financial Emergency	Escrow	Swiss Financial Cell		Geneva, Switzerland — +41 xx xxx xxxx
Diplomatic Convening	Crisis	Pakistan Authority	Co-Convening	Islamabad, Pakistan — +92 xx xxxx xxxx
Secretariat General		Joint Coordination Secretariat		Geneva, Switzerland — +41 xx xxx xxxx
Crisis Response Cell		24/7 Duty Officer		Muscat/Geneva — +968 xxxx xxxx

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